PLAYMAKER

SCENARIOS

Sixteen game moments: inbounds plays, late clock, the coach's call. Each one sets up the court, starts the clock part-way down and asks the offence for one thing: **an Excellent look, 30 or more.** Ten minutes each. Crunch Time: three cards each, add up the scores.

PLAYING A SCENARIO

- Pick a card. Take the two listed teams and set the pieces on the squares shown, with the arrows as drawn.
- Put the shot clock marker on the card's clock. Fill both pools. Then play by the normal rules, offence first.
- The goal is the **shot value** of your look: **30 or more** beats the scenario. Fouls and bonuses still add to the possession score.
- Swap roles and play the card again: the better score wins. On Late Clock cards, compare results first (win, then tie, then loss); shot value breaks ties.

INBOUNDS

- The inbounder (dashed ring) sits just off the court, beside the square shown, holding the ball. It cannot move.
- You have **two phases** to complete a pass from the inbounder. The clock does not run yet. The pass works like any other: it ends your turn, and the defence answers with 1 or 2 actions (move and Intercept, Sprint and Intercept, or move two players).
- Once the pass lands, after the defence's turn: reset to a new phase, put the clock marker on the card's clock, and the inbounder may step onto the court.
- Not in after two phases: a **turnover, –5**. Play on from where everyone stands, ball with the player furthest from the rim (offence picks if tied), clock on the card's number.

COACH'S CALL

Before setup, the offence secretly writes one player down: the target. Anyone may still shoot, but if the target takes the shot, add the bonus for how good the look was.

POOR	OKAY	GOOD	GREAT	EXCELLENT
+0	+2	+5	+8	+10

Reveal the paper after the shot. Executing the coach's intent is worth the most when the look is great.

LATE CLOCK

- The clock starts low, so every token matters. Run out of clock and it is a turnover, –5, plus a forced shot from where the pieces stand.
- **Need a Three:** only a three-point shot scores. **Two or Three:** an Excellent three wins; an Excellent two ties.

CONSTRAINTS

- The card states the rule that bends: tokens already spent, a locked star, a defence one foul from the bonus, a mismatch from a switch.
- A locked player (grey lock token) unlocks at the next phase reset, as normal. A T on a piece is a screen still standing.

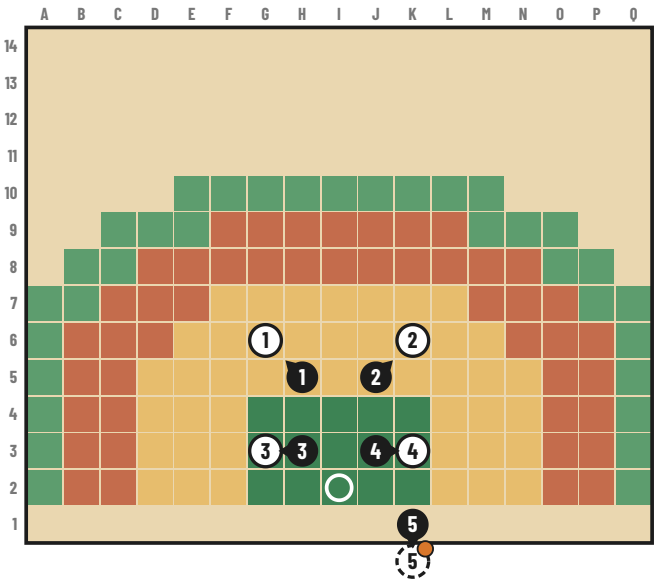
FOR COACHES

Each card is a drill. Set it, let the player run it, then ask what the defence gave up and why. Play it again from the other side.

1 Baseline Box

INBOUNDS · CLOCK 8

Inbound from the baseline beside the rim. The defence packs the lane, each player touching their man.



O · BUCKET BRIGADE 1 Scoring PG A · 2 Bucket Getter SG C · 3 Scoring SF C · 4 Post Scorer PF A · 5 Playmaking C B

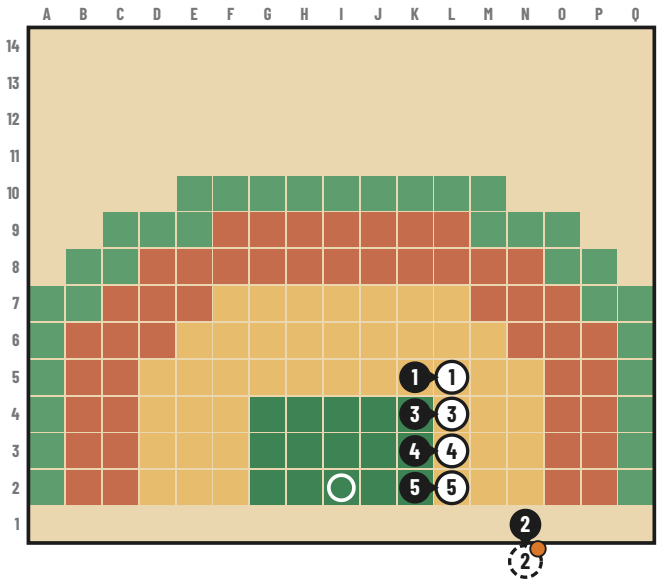
X · IRON WALL 1 Defensive PG B · 2 Bucket Getter SG B · 3 Defensive SF B · 4 Stretch PF B · 5 Rim Protector C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Inbounds: two phases to get it in, then the clock starts.

2 Baseline Stack

INBOUNDS · CLOCK 8

Inbound from the baseline corner. Four players stacked on the lane line, all defenders on the inside.



O · RUN AND GUN 1 Attacking PG B · 2 Two-Way SG B · 3 Scoring SF B · 4 Defensive PF A · 5 Rim Runner C C

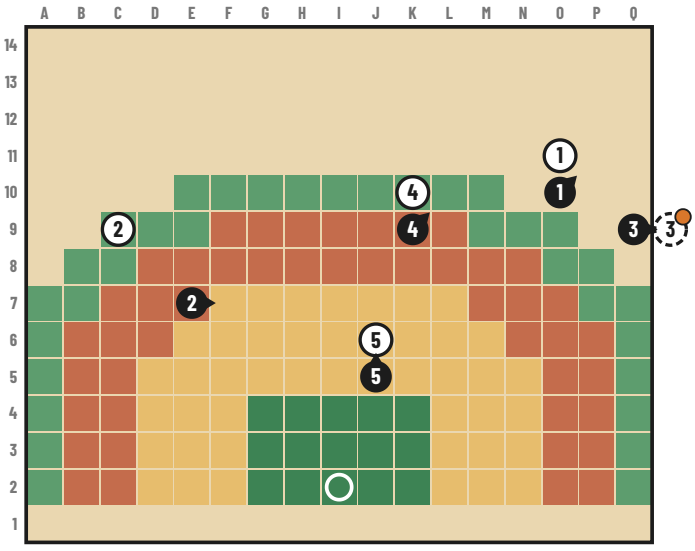
X · TWIN TOWERS 1 Scoring PG C · 2 Two-Way SG A · 3 Scoring SF A · 4 Post Scorer PF C · 5 Post Scorer C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Inbounds: two phases to get it in, then the clock starts.

3 Sideline Out

INBOUNDS · CLOCK 8

Inbound from the right wing. The weak-side defender is two passes away and sags into the lane.



O · BALL MOVEMENT 1 Pass-First PG A · 2 Sharpshooter SG C · 3 Point Forward SF B · 4 All-Rounder PF A · 5 Post Scorer C C

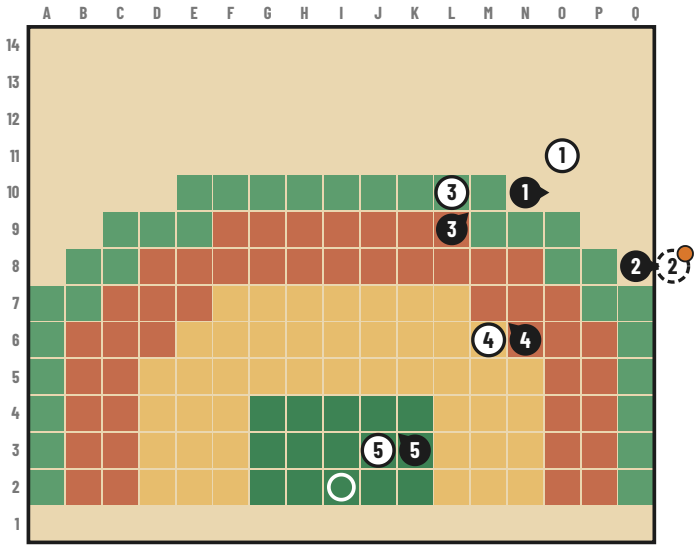
X · SHOOT AND PROTECT 1 Pass-First PG B · 2 Three-and-D SG A · 3 Stretch SF A · 4 Stretch PF C · 5 Rim Protector C C

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Inbounds: two phases to get it in, then the clock starts.

4 Deny Everything

INBOUNDS · CLOCK 8

Sideline inbound against a defence denying every lane. No pass is free: you must move to get open.



O · PACE AND SPACE 1 Combo Guard B · 2 Three-and-D SG B · 3 Stretch SF B · 4 Pick-and-Pop PF B · 5 Rim Runner C B

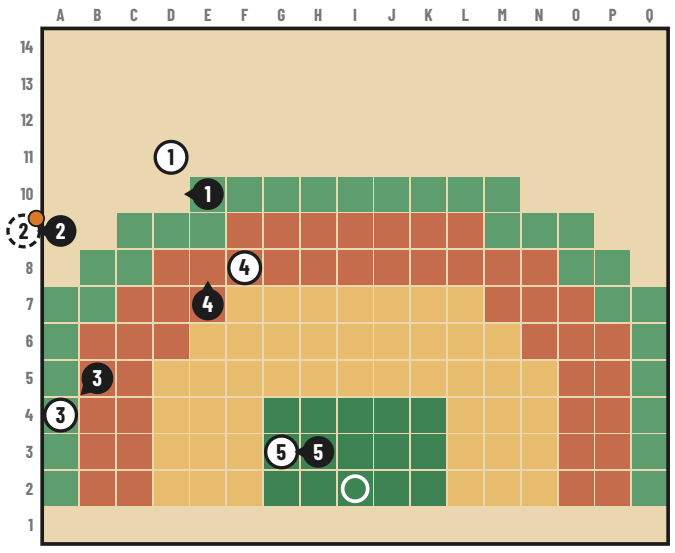
X · LOCKDOWN 1 Defensive PG C · 2 Three-and-D SG C · 3 Two-Way SF A · 4 Defensive PF B · 5 Playmaking C A

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Inbounds: two phases to get it in, then the clock starts.

5 INBOUNDS
Sideline, Late

CLOCK **4**

Inbound from the left wing, then 4 seconds: two phases to catch and score.



O · HIGH-LOW 1 Combo Guard A · 2 Playmaker SG C · 3 Stretch SF C · 4 All-Rounder PF B · 5 Post Scorer C A

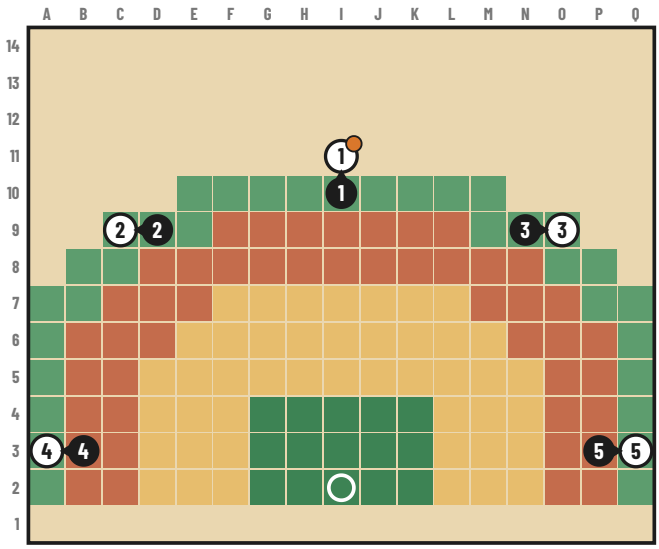
X · FIVE OUT 1 Pass-First PG C · 2 Sharpshooter SG A · 3 Two-Way SF B · 4 Stretch PF A · 5 Stretch C C

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Inbounds: two phases to get it in, then the clock starts.

6 LATE CLOCK
Need a Three

CLOCK **6**

Down 3. Only a three counts, and the defence knows it: nobody helps, everybody stays home.



O · FIVE OUT 1 Pass-First PG C · 2 Sharpshooter SG A · 3 Two-Way SF B · 4 Stretch PF A · 5 Stretch C C

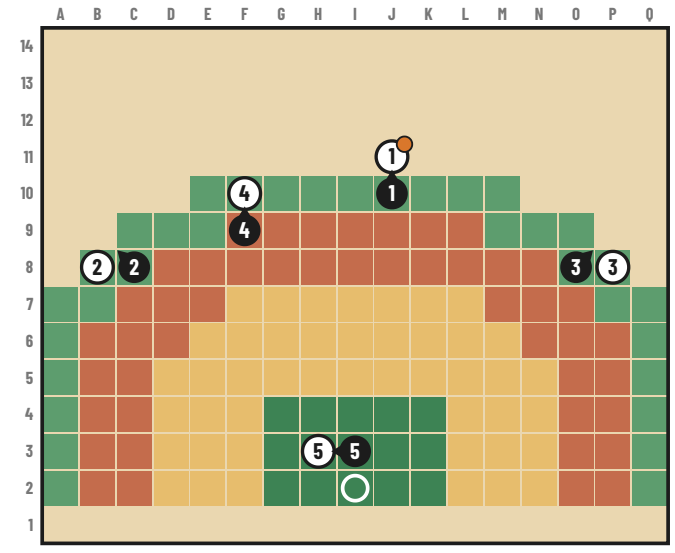
X · IRON WALL 1 Defensive PG B · 2 Bucket Getter SG B · 3 Defensive SF B · 4 Stretch PF B · 5 Rim Protector C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

7 LATE CLOCK
Two or Three

CLOCK **4**

Down 2. An Excellent three wins it; an Excellent two ties it.



O · SHOOT AND PROTECT 1 Pass-First PG B · 2 Three-and-D SG A · 3 Stretch SF A · 4 Stretch PF C · 5 Rim Protector C C

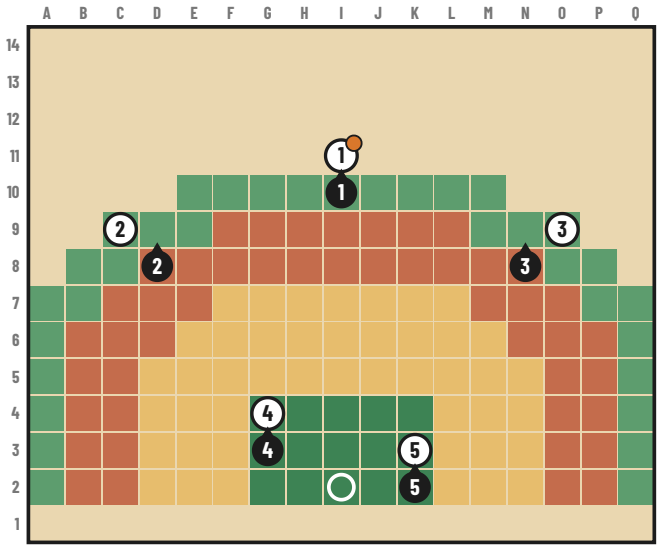
X · BUCKET BRIGADE 1 Scoring PG A · 2 Bucket Getter SG C · 3 Scoring SF C · 4 Post Scorer PF A · 5 Playmaking C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

8 COACH'S CALL
Coach's Call

CLOCK **8**

Before setup, secretly write the player you want to score. Run the play to get them the shot.



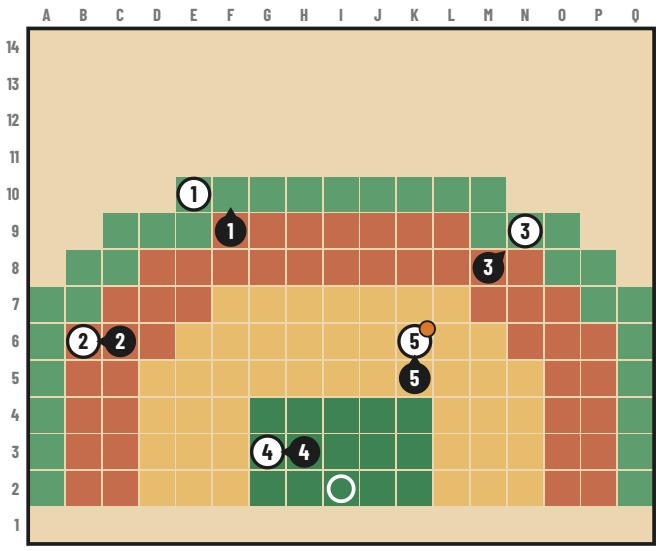
O · TWIN TOWERS 1 Scoring PG C · 2 Two-Way SG A · 3 Scoring SF A · 4 Post Scorer PF C · 5 Post Scorer C B

X · PACE AND SPACE 1 Combo Guard B · 2 Three-and-D SG B · 3 Stretch SF B · 4 Pick-and-Pop PF B · 5 Rim Runner C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Coach's Call: write your target first. Bonus +0 to +10.

9 COACH'S CALL — Coach's Call, Late — CLOCK 6

Secret target with 6 seconds left. The ball is with your centre at the elbow.



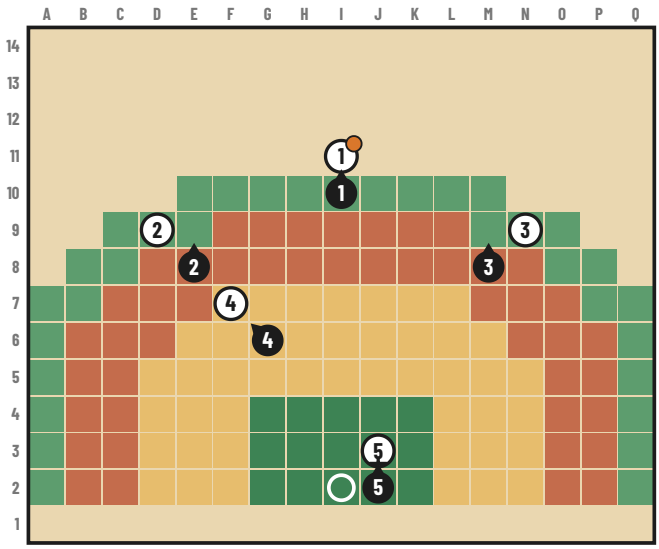
O · LOCKDOWN 1 Defensive PG C · 2 Three-and-D SG C · 3 Two-Way SF A · 4 Defensive PF B · 5 Playmaking C A

X · BALL MOVEMENT 1 Pass-First PG A · 2 Sharpshooter SG C · 3 Point Forward SF B · 4 All-Rounder PF A · 5 Post Scorer C C

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Coach's Call: write your target first. Bonus +0 to +10.

10 LATE CLOCK — Late Clock Reset — CLOCK 4

The set broke down. Both Screens are spent: O4's is down, O5's is still up. Offence has 4 tokens left, defence 4.



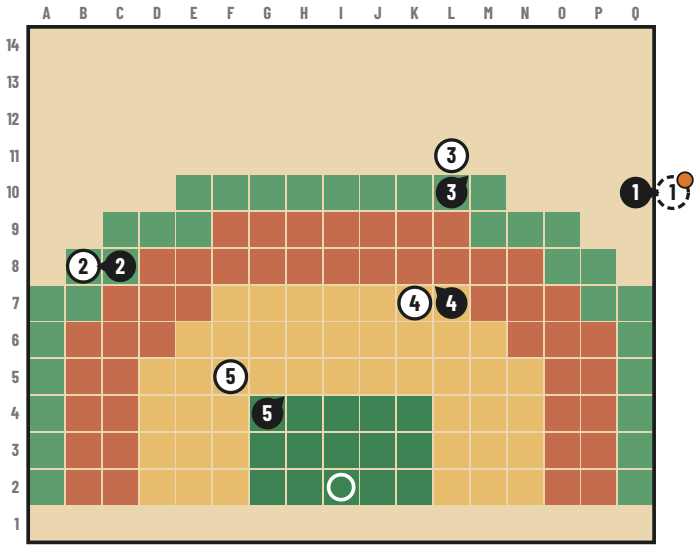
O · IRON WALL 1 Defensive PG B · 2 Bucket Getter SG B · 3 Defensive SF B · 4 Stretch PF B · 5 Rim Protector C B

X · RUN AND GUN 1 Attacking PG B · 2 Two-Way SG B · 3 Scoring SF B · 4 Defensive PF A · 5 Rim Runner C C

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

11 COACH'S CALL — After a Timeout — CLOCK 8

Sideline inbound after a timeout, with a secret target. Draw it up: the defence has to guess.



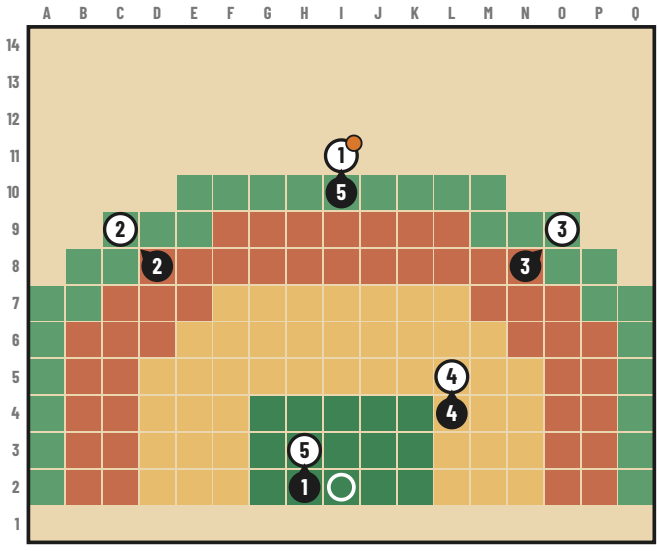
O · BALL MOVEMENT 1 Pass-First PG A · 2 Sharpshooter SG C · 3 Point Forward SF B · 4 All-Rounder PF A · 5 Post Scorer C C

X · HIGH-LOW 1 Combo Guard A · 2 Playmaker SG C · 3 Stretch SF C · 4 All-Rounder PF B · 5 Post Scorer C A

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.
Inbounds: two phases to get it in, then the clock starts.
Coach's Call: write your target first. Bonus +0 to +10.

12 CONSTRAINT — Mismatch on the Switch — CLOCK 6

A switch left X1, the point guard, on your post scorer, and X5 on the ball. The defence knows too.



O · TWIN TOWERS 1 Scoring PG C · 2 Two-Way SG A · 3 Scoring SF A · 4 Post Scorer PF C · 5 Post Scorer C B

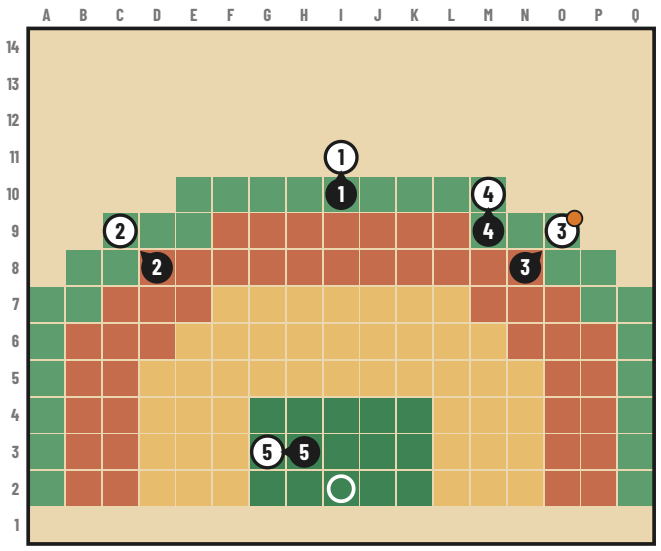
X · RUN AND GUN 1 Attacking PG B · 2 Two-Way SG B · 3 Scoring SF B · 4 Defensive PF A · 5 Rim Runner C C

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

13 LATE CLOCK — One Phase Left

CLOCK 2

Six tokens each, then the clock is gone. Every action has to count.



O · SHOOT AND PROTECT 1 Pass-First PG B · 2 Three-and-D SG A · 3 Stretch SF A · 4 Stretch PF C · 5 Rim Protector C C

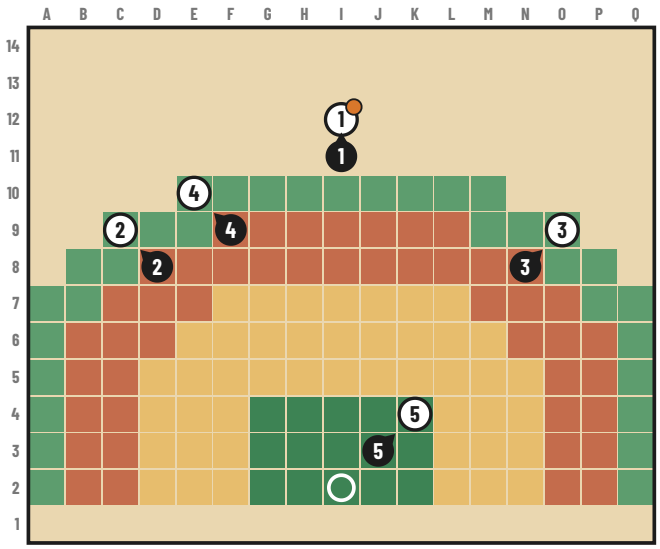
X · LOCKDOWN 1 Defensive PG C · 2 Three-and-D SG C · 3 Two-Way SF A · 4 Defensive PF B · 5 Playmaking C A

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

14 CONSTRAINT — Hold for One

CLOCK 8

Last shot of the quarter. No shot before the final phase (clock on 2). A turnover ends it at 0.



O · PACE AND SPACE 1 Combo Guard B · 2 Three-and-D SG B · 3 Stretch SF B · 4 Pick-and-Pop PF B · 5 Rim Runner C B

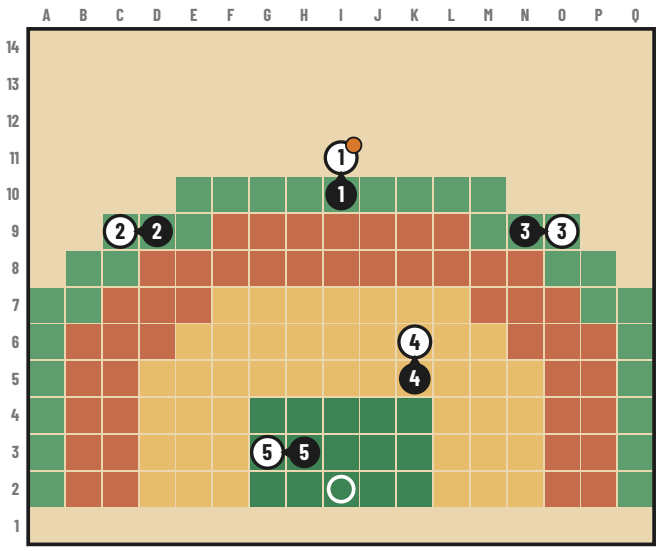
X · HIGH-LOW 1 Combo Guard A · 2 Playmaker SG C · 3 Stretch SF C · 4 All-Rounder PF B · 5 Post Scorer C A

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

15 CONSTRAINT — In the Bonus

CLOCK 8

The defence has one steal foul: start on +5, and its next steal foul gives +5 and free throws. The goal is still a 30+ look.



O · HIGH-LOW 1 Combo Guard A · 2 Playmaker SG C · 3 Stretch SF C · 4 All-Rounder PF B · 5 Post Scorer C A

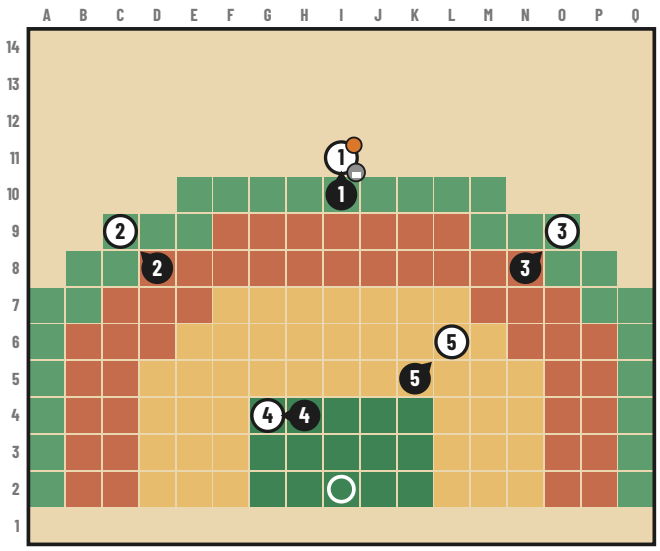
X · BUCKET BRIGADE 1 Scoring PG A · 2 Bucket Getter SG C · 3 Scoring SF C · 4 Post Scorer PF A · 5 Playmaking C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.

16 CONSTRAINT — Star Locked

CLOCK 6

Your star picked up the ball and is locked until the phase resets. He can still pass or shoot.



O · BUCKET BRIGADE 1 Scoring PG A · 2 Bucket Getter SG C · 3 Scoring SF C · 4 Post Scorer PF A · 5 Playmaking C B

X · IRON WALL 1 Defensive PG B · 2 Bucket Getter SG B · 3 Defensive SF B · 4 Stretch PF B · 5 Rim Protector C B

Goal: an Excellent look, 30+.